

COMPARISON · MATRIX · STRUCTURE

# matrix-grid

Two ordered axes as an  $N \times M$  chart-family grid — each cell marks a position (filled / reachable / not applicable), colored by its row's category from the theme's chart palette.

# Your level is a cell, not a rung.

*Your title is the diagonal — the same verb at a wider reach is a different level.*

|                    |            | WIDER REACH ► |        |           |               |
|--------------------|------------|---------------|--------|-----------|---------------|
|                    |            | SELF          | TEAM   | ORG       | FIELD         |
| DEEPER COGNITION ▲ | Create     |               |        |           | Distinguished |
|                    | Evaluate   |               |        | Principal |               |
|                    | Analyze    |               |        | Staff     |               |
|                    | Apply      |               | Senior |           |               |
|                    | Understand | Mid           |        |           |               |
|                    | Remember   | Junior        |        |           |               |

● Your level · ○ where you can operate when called for — illustrative, placements vary by company.

# Six categories by five columns is the grid's practical ceiling.

|                    |           | WIDER REACH ► |         |          |     |       |
|--------------------|-----------|---------------|---------|----------|-----|-------|
|                    |           | SELF          | PAIR    | TEAM     | ORG | FIELD |
| DEEPER COGNITION ▲ | Vision    |               |         |          |     | Chief |
|                    | Strategy  |               |         |          | VP  |       |
|                    | Execution |               |         | Director |     |       |
|                    | Delivery  |               | Manager |          |     |       |
|                    | Craft     | Senior        |         |          |     |       |
|                    | Basics    | Associate     |         |          |     |       |

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|--------------------|------------|---------------|--------|-----------|---------------|
|                    |            | SELF          | TEAM   | ORG       | FIELD         |
| DEEPER COGNITION ▲ | Create     |               |        |           | Distinguished |
|                    | Evaluate   |               |        | Principal |               |
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# When NOT to reach for matrix-grid.

## Pass/fail or delivery status

If cells mean shipped/at-risk/blocked, use `obligation-matrix` or `roadmap` — their semantic state palette (pass/warn/fail) is built for exactly that read, and matrix-grid's categorical row colors would mislead.

## More than one filled cell per row

Each row names one position — one `[x]`. Multiple filled cells in a row breaks the "this is where you are" read; use `[-]` for the cells the row can still reach.

## Unordered axes

The grid earns its shape when both axes have a real order (shallow to deep, narrow to wide). Two free categorical labels belong in `matrix-2x2`.

RELATED COMPONENTS

# See also.

`obligation-matrix` — rows × columns of pass/partial/exempt status, not a single position

`roadmap` — phases × workstreams delivery status

`matrix-2x2` — two free axes, four cells, qualitative placement

`verdict-grid` — options scored against shared criteria, one card per option